

RTI audit, wave 1: filings and early responses

Preliminary report consistent with the pre-analysis plan

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Scope and discipline

This report covers what the pre-analysis plan (design document v0.1, Sections 2 and 5) allows before outcomes are observed: the drawn and realised samples, balance, filing-stage access costs, exposure time, and the early-response hazard. As of 24 September 2026 no filed application has reached its 30-day statutory deadline, so response incidence is unobserved for the entire sample. Treatment arms appear only where the plan treats them as design or pre-treatment quantities: the design table, the filing-attrition test, and balance. No outcome is tabulated by arm; that begins once the plan is posted and the day-30 horizon has passed for the Tamil Nadu batch.

1 Drawn samples

Table 1: Drawn samples by state (frozen assignment files)

State	N	Plain / Legal	Tiers	RA1/RA2/RA3/RA4	Strata
Tamil Nadu	1000	700 / 300	Sub Office 824; Head of Department 136; Department 40	250/250/250/250	115
Telangana	250	175 / 75	single tier (portal roster)	63/63/62/62	71
Karnataka	180	126 / 54	single tier (portal roster)	45/45/45/45	73
Delhi	22	15 / 7	single tier (portal roster)	6/6/5/5	16
Maharashtra	33	23 / 10	single tier (portal roster)	8/8/9/8	21
All	1485	1039 / 446			

Notes: Batches: Tamil Nadu **b2026q3.02** (seed 20260817), Telangana **tg2026q3.02** (20260903), Karnataka **ka2026q3.01** (20260907), Delhi and Maharashtra **dm2026q3.01** (20260908). Tamil Nadu is stratified by department $\times$ tier from the crawled 17,417-office universe; the other states are drawn from portal rosters stratified by department group. Salience is a seeded 70/30 draw within each batch; RA assignment is round-robin within strata.

*Prepared with Gaurav Sood in view. Data as of 24 September 2026. Every table is generated by `reports/report1_filings/analysis.py` in the `rti-responses` repository from the frozen assignment files, the RAs' filing sheets and receipts, and the coded responses.

2 Realised filing and attrition

Table 2: Filing progress by state and arm, as of 24 September 2026

State	Drawn	Filed	Filed (%)	Plain (%)	Legal (%)	Difference (pp)
Tamil Nadu	1000	141	14	13	16	+2.2
Telangana	250	187	75	74	76	+1.7
Karnataka	180	73	41	37	48	+10.8
Delhi	22	6	27	27	29	+1.9
Maharashtra	33	9	27	26	30	+3.9
All	1485	416	28	27	30	+3.2

Notes: “Filed” means a portal receipt is uploaded to the shared drive or the RA’s sheet records a registration number or filing date (416 applications, of which 394 have receipts). Filing is in progress, so the filed share is a throughput measure, not attrition; the arm difference is the pre-treatment check that RAs did not file selectively by letter type. Tamil Nadu, the fully stratified batch: a linear probability model of filed-by-24 September 2026 on the legal-salience indicator with 115 department $\times$ tier stratum fixed effects gives -0.4 pp (HC1 s.e. 2.0), $p = 0.84$; randomisation inference within strata (2,000 permutations) gives $p = 0.64$.

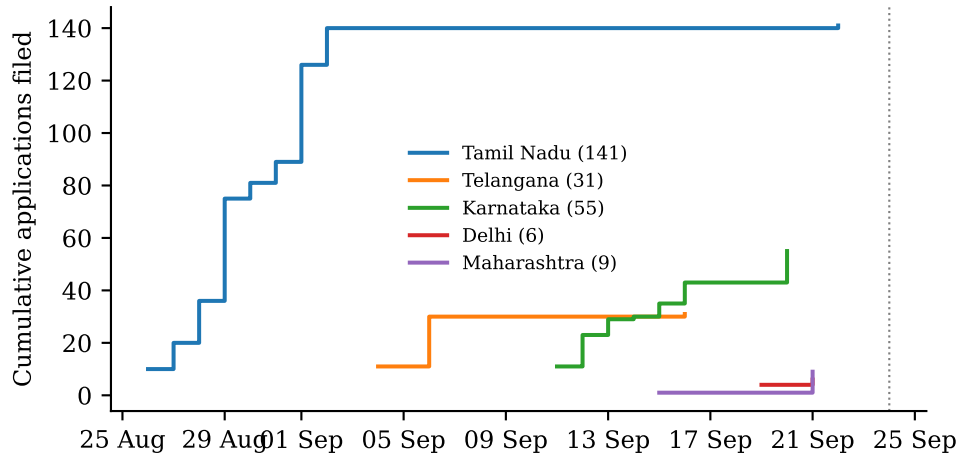


Figure 1: Cumulative filings by state

Notes: Applications with a recorded filing date (242 of 416). Telangana dates are under-recorded in the RA sheets (31 of 187); receipt OCR will fill them.

Table 3: Balance of the filed Tamil Nadu sample across arms

	Filed	Plain	Legal	Legal (%)
<i>Tier</i>				
Department	7	0	7	100
Head of Department	21	15	6	29
Sub Office	113	79	34	30
<i>Research assistant</i>				
RA1	75	50	25	33
RA2	66	44	22	33
All filed, Tamil Nadu	141	94	47	33

Notes: Chi-square tests of independence between arm and tier ($p = 0.00$) and between arm and research assistant ($p = 1.00$). The draw is balanced by construction; imbalance in the filed subset reflects the order in which RAs have worked through their lists and will close as filing completes. It is reported so that any early-window comparison would be read with it.

3 Filing-stage access costs

Table 4: What an online filer faces, by state portal

State	Portal	Universe	VPN	OTP	CAPTCHAs	Fee channel	Text limit	Identity demand
Tamil Nadu	Portal, own software	17,417 offices, 40 depts	Yes	No	1	Rs 10 online	3,000 chars	None
Telangana	Portal, own software	3,401 offices	Yes	SMS	2	Rs 10 online	3,000 chars	None
Karnataka	Portal, NIC RTI Online	1,800 nodal officers	Yes	Email + SMS	3	Rs 10 via treasury gateway (UPI)	3,000 chars	None
Delhi	Portal, NIC RTI Online	223 authorities	No	Email	1–2	Rs 10 online	3,000 chars	None
Maharashtra	Portal, NIC RTI Online	328 authorities	No	Email	1–2	Rs 10 online	150 words	None
Rajasthan	Portal, own software	not enumerated	No	Optional	1	Rs 10 online	–	ID number and scan; state address

Notes: From the RAs’ screen recordings, portal field inventories and filing notes. “VPN” means the portal is unreachable from outside India. Rajasthan was dropped from the frame at this stage: the portal requires an identity-document number and scan and a Rajasthan postal address, which is itself a frame-level finding. Maharashtra’s 150-word cap forced a condensed instrument (v4) for its 33 assignments; Delhi keeps v3. RA minutes per filing from the hours sheet will be added in the next version.

4 Exposure and the early-response hazard

Table 5: Exposure of filed applications, as of 24 September 2026

State	Filed	Receipts	Dated	Filing window	Median days	Max days	Past day 30
Tamil Nadu	141	128	141	26 Aug – 22 Sep	26	29	0
Telangana	187	186	31	04 Sep – 16 Sep	18	20	0
Karnataka	73	73	55	11 Sep – 20 Sep	11	13	0
Delhi	6	6	6	19 Sep – 21 Sep	5	5	0
Maharashtra	9	1	9	15 Sep – 21 Sep	3	9	0
All	416	394	242		23	29	0

Notes: Days from the portal’s date of filing to 24 September 2026. No application has reached the statutory deadline; the earliest Tamil Nadu filings (26 August) reach day 30 on 25 September, Karnataka’s on 12 October, Telangana’s from 4 October.

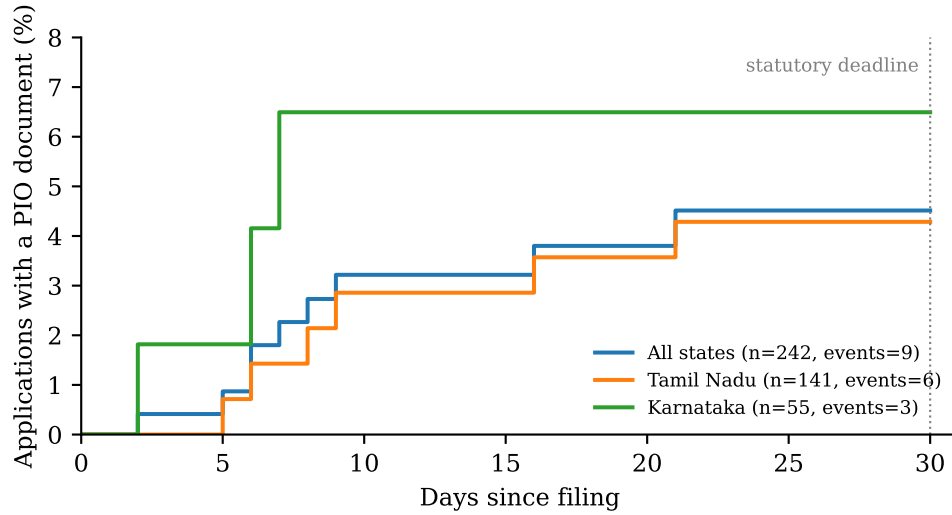


Figure 2: Cumulative incidence of a PIO document by days since filing (Kaplan–Meier, censored at 24 September 2026)

Notes: Event = any PIO document dated t days after filing (portal reply, letter, transfer, fee demand, or return). Applications without an event are censored at their exposure. Estimates: 2.3% by day 7 (211 at risk), 3.2% by day 14 (166), 4.5% by day 21 (135), 4.5% by day 28 (19 at risk). The plan’s primary display is Kaplan–Meier by stratum with censoring at 90 and 180 days; this is the same object truncated at day 30 and pooled because there are 9 events.

Postal replies are dated by the PIO’s letter, which precedes receipt.

5 The first responses

Table 6: The 9 responses received, coded on the plan’s ladder (SI C), without arm

ID	Authority	Filed	Replied	Days	Via	Disposition	Granularity	Fee
KA-055	Hassan Urban Development Cell (DUDC)	12 Sep	19 Sep	7	portal	Returned	None	–
KA-057	Dy Commissioner of Excise, Ballari	12 Sep	18 Sep	6	portal	Partial	A: register rows	–
KA-102	Labour Officer, Vijayanagara	14 Sep	16 Sep	2	portal	Partial	Prose only	–
TN-052	Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Department (Secretariat)	26 Aug	03 Sep	8	post	Partial	C: totals	–
TN-057	Asst Director of Seed Certification, Dharmapuri	28 Aug	18 Sep	21	post	Full	A + B	–
TN-173	Co-operation, Food and Consumer Protection Department (Secretariat)	29 Aug	03 Sep	5	post	Fee pending	C: totals	Rs 832
TN-223	TANGEDCO, Superintending Engineer, Tirupur	30 Aug	05 Sep	6	post	Transferred	None	–
TN-283	Directorate of Sericulture	02 Sep	18 Sep	16	portal	Fee pending	A: register rows	Rs 138
TN-308	Directorate of Family Welfare	01 Sep	10 Sep	9	post	Denied (deflection)	None	–

Notes: Single-coder first pass, to be replaced by double coding. “Denied (deflection)” covers a refusal without an exemption clause that points elsewhere (a portal return; “file a separate application”; “see cic.gov.in”). “Fee pending” means the register was offered on payment at the lawful Rs 2 per page. Granularity follows the letter’s ladder: A = one row per RTI application in the office’s register; B = monthly or category counts; C = period totals. Only one of the nine honoured the request for scanned supply by email.

What comes next

Day-30 outcomes for Tamil Nadu accumulate from 25 September; the first-results memo at day 45 (mid-October) reports the plan's primary display by stratum and the day-30 incidence, with the legal-salience contrast only after the plan is posted. Two data tasks precede it: complete the filing dates from receipt OCR (Telangana), and move response intake to the event log so that receipt dates, not dispatch dates, drive the survival clock.